



Following South Africa's impactful leadership in the G20 and B20, this edition highlights the progress and strategic projects positioning Gauteng for an ambitious 2026.



MESSAGE FROM THE ACTING GROUP CEO

As we bring 2025 to a close, I would like to express my great pride in everything the Gauteng Growth and Development Agency (GGDA) has achieved this year, and extend my heartfelt thanks to our dynamic team and the many dedicated partners who have walked this journey with us. Despite a demanding global environment, the GGDA has continued to deliver on its mandate through focused interventions that strengthened investment flows, infrastructure delivery, and inclusive economic participation.

One of the defining milestones of the year was the successful hosting of the inaugural Gauteng Investment Conference (GIC), which secured strong investor commitments across priority sectors. As many as 14 of the 60 projects have already been implemented with a combined value of R61.2 billion, translating these commitments into measurable economic impact.

In addition to supporting investment facilitation, the GGDA made demonstrable progress in strengthening Gauteng's economic foundations. Work on the Vaal Special Economic Zone (SEZ) advanced toward gazetting, while feasibility processes at Lanseria and the Vaal continued in preparation for implementation in the new financial year. Across the broader infrastructure portfolio, projects have progressed

steadily, supported by intergovernmental coordination to address any constraints and keep delivery on track.

Skills development and market access stood out as areas of real significance during the year. Across the group, targeted programmes reached a wide base of beneficiaries. At Constitution Hill, the Creative Uprising Programme supported 945 participants, helping township-based creatives and small, medium, and microenterprises (SMMEs) formalise, grow, and participate further in local value chains.

The Innovation Hub (TIH) trained 645 young people through digital skills programmes, while the Automotive Industry Development Centre (AIDC) supported more than 577 individuals with automotive and workplace skills. Within the Gauteng Industrial Development Zone (GIDZ) ecosystem, another 37 SMMEs completed business development and masterclass training in collaboration with the Gordon Institute of Business Science (GIBS).

Market access initiatives also made an impact. Through the Global Export Passport Programme, implemented with the Department of Trade, Industry and Competition (DTIC), more than 187 companies have been trained to date, with a year-end target of 300. These firms received support to access new markets, trade platforms, and financing, contributing to over R6.3 billion in trade deals facilitated across key sectors including manufacturing, agro-processing, rail infrastructure, cosmetics, and automotive.

Looking ahead, our focus for 2026 will be to continue strengthening the investment pipeline, improving SEZ performance, supporting emerging enterprises, and accelerating initiatives that position Gauteng within the green and digital economies. Financial sustainability and disciplined delivery will remain central to this effort.

Thank you again for your engagement and support throughout the year. I wish you and your loved ones a safe and restful holiday season, and I look forward to continuing to build on the foundation laid in 2025 as we step into a new year of possibility.

Stembiso Dlamini

Acting Group CEO



GAUTENG STRENGTHENS AFRICA-EU ECONOMIC PARTNERSHIPS AHEAD OF GIC 2026

At the 12th Southern Africa-Europe CEO Dialogue last month, Gauteng MEC for Finance Lebogang Maile addressed business leaders and policymakers from across Africa and Europe. He described the dialogue as "a strategic instrument of economic diplomacy," where shared priorities are turning into concrete investment frameworks.

MEC Maile noted that these engagements are taking place during a time of rising global inequality, as seen in the 2025 G20 Global Inequality Report tabled under South Africa's Presidency. The report shows that 83% of countries are facing high inequality and that the richest one percent has absorbed 41% of new wealth over the past two decades. It also warns that declining labour income, weakening institutional trust, and persistent structural constraints in developing economies threaten long-term global stability.

Against this backdrop, he emphasised Gauteng's central role in the region's economic engine. The province contributes around one third of South Africa's GDP and a meaningful share of Sub-Saharan Africa's output, and national exports into the continent through a well-established logistics network. These strengths reinforce Gauteng's position as a gateway for companies seeking access to African markets.

He highlighted increasing alignment between Africa's development priorities and European investment interests, especially in renewable energy, advanced manufacturing, mobility technologies, digital



infrastructure, and research-driven industries. Gauteng's Pan-African Economic Partnership Mobilisation Programme is intended to widen these opportunities by strengthening regional trade and investment pathways.

MEC Maile confirmed that the next Gauteng Investment Conference (GIC) will take place in April 2026, and will present implementation-ready projects in renewable energy, green hydrogen, SEZ-based manufacturing, electric mobility, modern logistics systems, digital infrastructure, and innovation ecosystems.

"The next chapter of the Africa-Europe partnership will not be written in communiqués. It will be written in projects, factories, energy plants, logistics hubs, research labs, and innovation ecosystems," he said.

GIC 2025 AT A GLANCE

- R312.5 billion in pledges
- 60 major projects
- More than 91,500 potential jobs

ACCELERATING GAUTENG'S INVESTMENT PIPELINE

As Gauteng prepares for the 2026 Gauteng Investment Conference (GIC) in April, the province is entering a decisive phase in advancing its investment pipeline. Pipeline projects for 2026 across the Central, Northern, Eastern and Southern corridors already represent a combined value of R55.82 billion, driven by strong investor demand in ICT, property development, advanced manufacturing, automotive technologies, and logistics.

Further demonstrating positive signs of progress, by the end of 2025, 22% of GIC-linked projects had already moved into implementation, representing R59 billion in activity. Building on this momentum, the implementation outlook for 2026 shows a significant shift of projects into the 12 to 24-month delivery window, supported by improved facilitation and clearer timelines.

The pipeline distribution reflected in the EXCO report indicates growing depth across all corridors. The Central corridor has seen a strong concentration of large-scale ICT and property developments. The Northern corridor's growth has centred on aviation, automotive and manufacturing, while the Eastern and Southern corridors continue to attract investment in industrial facilities, steel production, and agro-processing. This spread positions Gauteng to support a balanced regional growth trajectory.

Job creation prospects for 2026 are also strong. Based on historical multipliers applied to similar project categories, the current pipeline is expected to support 91 500 jobs over the next two years, particularly in construction, ICT, manufacturing, and logistics.

With strong traction behind catalytic precincts, Gauteng is positioning 2026 as a year of acceleration in both investment delivery and inclusive economic growth.

GIC PROJECT IMPLEMENTATION SNAPSHOT

Status

- Implemented: 14 projects | R61.2 billion
- Up to 12 months: 15 projects | R81.2 billion
- 13-24 months: 17 projects | R114.0 billion

Top 5 sectors

- Property development – 72.5%
- ICT – 17.6%
- Steel – 3.6%
- Agro-processing – 3.3%
- Mining – 1.5%



INFRASTRUCTURE PROGRESS AND DEVELOPMENT

The GGDA's Enterprise Project Management Office (EPMO) continues to advance key infrastructure programmes across Gauteng, strengthening community development and local participation. Below follows a brief overview of some of the flagship projects advancing through the EPMO this year:

1. Ga Rankuwa Hotel School

Now in Stage 3 detailed design, the redevelopment of the Ga Rankuwa Hotel School is set to transform the campus into a fully CATHSSETA-compliant centre of excellence. With new teaching kitchens, a commercial restaurant, conference and event spaces, upgraded student accommodation, and hands-on learning facilities, the school will provide world-class hospitality and tourism education while supporting local small businesses.

2. Constitution Hill Visitor Centre

The four-storey Visitor Centre, currently in Stage 5 construction, is taking shape as a consolidated and heritage-sensitive gateway for exhibitions, events, and public education. Once complete, it will unify reception, ticketing, exhibitions, information services, and an amphitheatre into a single, accessible hub. Several SMMEs are engaged on the project, contributing to job creation and specialist skills development.

3. Constitution Hill "We the People's Park"

Recently completed by the GGDA, the park complements Constitution Hill's cultural landmarks and strengthens the precinct's role as an important centre for human rights education and urban renewal. Developed with strong community and SMME

participation, it offers an inclusive, heritage-aligned civic space that reinforces the site's democratic and cultural significance.

4. Vaal/Heidelberg bulk infrastructure

The Heidelberg bulk infrastructure project is in its early construction phase, preparing 102 hectares at Heidelberg Extension 24 for future business development. With the installation of roads, stormwater drainage, water and sewage pipelines, and bulk electricity, the site will become investment ready for factories, logistics hubs, and agro processing.

5. Constitution Hill ramparts refurbishment

The ramparts refurbishment project, currently in Stage 5 construction, is revitalising Constitution Hill's historic stone retaining walls and ramparts building, with careful structural assessments, rebuilding, concrete casting, waterproofing, and civil works. Once complete, the ramparts will be structurally sound and weather tight, enhancing public safety while preserving the precinct's heritage and character.

6. Township industrial parks

The GGDA has launched the refurbishment of four township industrial parks, namely Fannie Malape Hive in Thokoza, Atteridgeville 2, Emdeni in Soweto, and Rosslyn in Pretoria North. The sites are now ready for Stage 5 construction, and the upgrades will restore safe, compliant facilities for SMMEs and cooperatives, enabling local businesses and township entrepreneurs to access modern facilities, while boosting confidence in township industrial infrastructure.



OUR SUBSIDIARIES

BUILDING GAUTENG'S COMPETITIVENESS TOGETHER

Through our subsidiaries, including the Automotive Industry Development Centre, The Innovation Hub, OR Tambo SEZ, Vaal SEZ and Constitution Hill, the GGDA builds partnerships and ecosystems that drive innovation, attract investment and strengthen Gauteng's competitiveness.

STAY CONNECTED

The GGDA remains committed to driving economic transformation, creating opportunities, and positioning Gauteng as a globally competitive region. We invite stakeholders to continue engaging with us, collaborating on projects, and investing in the province's future